

TRANSFORMING WASTE

ALUMINUM RECYCLING

Aluminum is one of the most recycled and valuable materials in our recycling bins. What makes the metal so useful are its physical properties, which allow it to be molded into new shapes easily. Products made of aluminum can be collected, melted, and easily made into new ones. Recycling aluminum from products, such as old cans, foil, and even old car parts, uses nearly 95 percent less energy than making aluminum from its raw ore.

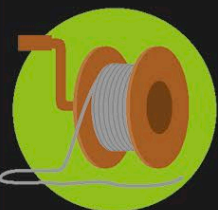
RECYCLED PRODUCTS

Over two-thirds of drink cans in the US and Europe are made of recycled aluminum. Every year, more than 40 billion cans are recycled in the US and about 31 billion cans are recycled in Europe.



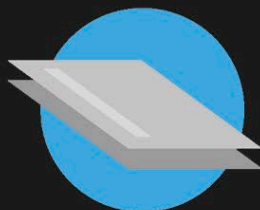
PROPERTIES OF ALUMINUM

Aluminum belongs to a group of materials called metals, which all have similar properties. Like all other metals, aluminum allows heat and electricity to pass through it easily. Like most other metals, aluminum is strong and has a shiny silver surface. But unlike many metals, aluminum does not easily corrode.



Ductility

Aluminum can be stretched into wires without breaking or losing its strength.



Malleability

Its malleability allows aluminum to be hammered into new shapes such as sheets.



Strength

Strong and long-lasting, aluminum can resist a force without breaking.

